पशवः पक्षिणश्च

My Sanskrit Animals Workbook

संस्कृत-पशुपक्षि-अभ्यास-पुस्तिका

Domestic & wild animals · birds · water creatures · insects · sounds · sentences · vāhanas · a Pañcatantra story · subhāṣitas · word search · colouring

Name / नाम: _____



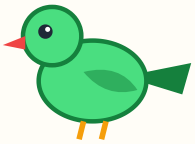
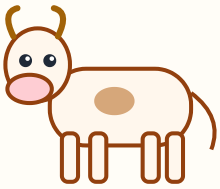
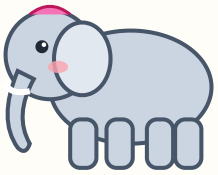
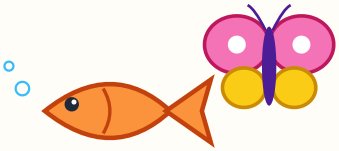
Free to print and share

How to use · Contents

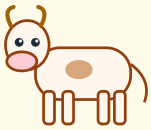
1. Look at each picture and read the Sanskrit name aloud, then the sound (transliteration).
2. Do the practice page that follows each set of words.
3. Read the sentences, the Pañcatantra story and the subhāṣitas slowly; learn one line a day.
4. Finish with the word search, the colouring page and the mixed quiz. Answers are at the end.

Contents

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Domestic animals · ग्राम्यपशवः



गौः
gauḥ
cow



अश्वः
aśvaḥ
horse



अजा
ajā
goat (she-goat); अजः he-goat



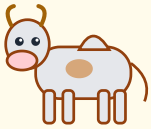
श्वा · कुक्कुरः
śvā · kukkuraḥ
dog



मार्जारः
mārjāraḥ
cat



कुक्कुटः
kukkuṭaḥ
rooster; कुक्कुटी hen



वृषभः
vṛṣabhaḥ
bull, ox



मूषकः
mūṣakaḥ
mouse, rat

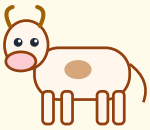
More words

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
महिषी	mahiṣī	she-buffalo (महिषः buffalo)
उष्ट्रः	uṣṭraḥ	camel
गर्दभः	gardabhaḥ	donkey
मेषः	meṣaḥ	sheep, ram

पशुः (paśuḥ) = animal. ग्राम्य = of the village, domestic.

Practice: domestic animals

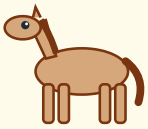
Write the Sanskrit name under each picture.



_____



_____



_____



_____

Match

1. मार्जारः	a. camel
2. गर्दभः	b. cat
3. उष्ट्रः	c. bull
4. वृषभः	d. donkey
5. मेषः	e. sheep

Fill in

1. A dog is _____ or कुक्कुरः.
2. A she-goat is _____.
3. The mouse is _____.

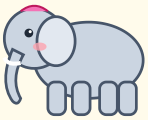
Wild animals · वन्यपशवः



सिंहः
siṃhaḥ
lion



व्याघ्रः
vyāghraḥ
tiger



गजः · हस्ती
gajaḥ · hastī
elephant



वानरः · कपिः
vānaraḥ · kapiḥ
monkey



हरिणः · मृगः
hariṇaḥ · mṛgaḥ
deer



शशकः
śaśakaḥ
hare, rabbit



भल्लूकः
bhallūkaḥ
bear



सर्पः
sarpaḥ
snake

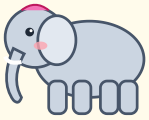
More words

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
शृगालः	śṛgālaḥ	jackal
वृकः	vṛkaḥ	wolf
वराहः	varāhaḥ	wild boar
गण्डकः	gaṇḍakaḥ	rhinoceros

वन्य = of the forest (वनम्), wild.

Practice: wild animals

Write the Sanskrit name under each picture.



_____



_____



_____



_____

Odd one out · भिन्नं चिनुत

1. सिंहः · व्याघ्रः · गौः · भल्लूकः → _____
2. वानरः · कपिः · मार्जारः → _____ (two words mean the same; which is different?)
3. शशकः · वराहः · शुकः · वृकः → _____

Write in Sanskrit

1. tiger _____
2. bear _____
3. jackal _____
4. snake _____

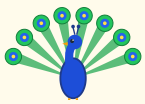
Birds · पक्षिणः



काकः
kākaḥ
crow



शुकः
śukaḥ
parrot



मयूरः
mayūraḥ
peacock



कोकिलः · पिकः
kokilaḥ · pikaḥ
Indian cuckoo (koel)



हंसः
haṃsaḥ
swan, goose



उलूकः
ulūkaḥ
owl



चटका
caṭakā
sparrow



श्येनः
śyenaḥ
hawk, falcon

More words

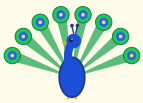
Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
कपोतः	kapotaḥ	pigeon, dove
बकः	bakaḥ	heron, egret
गृध्रः	gṛdhraḥ	vulture
सारसः	sārasaḥ	sarus crane
खगः · पक्षी	khagaḥ · pakṣī	bird (general words)

Practice: birds

Write the Sanskrit name under each picture.



_____



_____



_____



_____

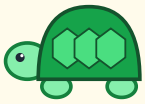
Fill in

1. The _____ sings sweetly in spring.
2. The black bird that caws is the _____.
3. A pigeon is _____.
4. Two general words for “bird”: _____ and _____.

Water creatures · जलचराः



मत्स्यः
matsyaḥ
fish



कूर्मः
kūrmaḥ
turtle, tortoise



मण्डूकः
maṇḍūkaḥ
frog

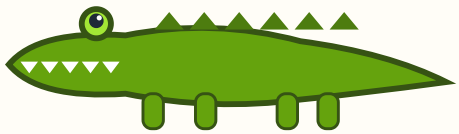


कर्कटः
karkaṭaḥ
crab

More words

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
नक्रः · मकरः	nakraḥ · makaraḥ	crocodile
तिमिङ्गिलः	timiṅgilaḥ	a huge sea creature; used for “whale”
शङ्खः	śaṅkhaḥ	conch
शुक्तिः	śuktiḥ	oyster shell, pearl oyster
जलचरः	jalacaraḥ	water creature (“one that moves in water”)







मकरः is the crocodile-like creature that carries Gaṅgā; it is also the zodiac sign Makara.

Insects · कीटाः



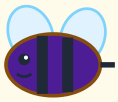
पिपीलिका
pipīlikā
ant



मधुमक्षिका
madhumakṣikā
honeybee



चित्रपतङ्गः
citrapataṅgaḥ
butterfly



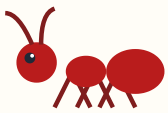
भ्रमरः
bhramaraḥ
large black bee

More words

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
मक्षिका	makṣikā	fly
मशकः	maśakaḥ	mosquito
खद्योतः	khadyotaḥ	firefly
कीटः	kīṭaḥ	insect, small creature (general word)

ऊर्णनाभः (ūrṇanābhaḥ, spider) and वृश्चिकः (vṛścikaḥ, scorpion) have eight legs, so they are not insects. Insects have six legs.

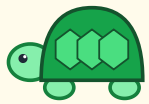






Practice: water creatures & insects

Write the Sanskrit name under each picture.



_____



_____



_____



_____

Where does it live? Write जले (in water) or स्थले (on land)

1. मत्स्यः _____
2. पिपीलिका _____
3. नक्रः _____ and _____
4. मधुमक्षिका _____

True or false

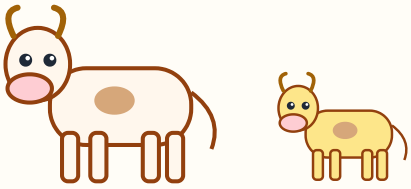
1. A spider (ऊर्णनाभः) is an insect. _____
2. मशकः means mosquito. _____

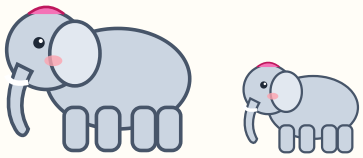
Young ones & female forms · शावकाः स्त्रियश्च

Young ones	Sound	Meaning
वत्सः	vatsaḥ	calf (young of a cow)
कलभः	kalabhaḥ	young elephant
किशोरः	kiśoraḥ	colt (young horse)
शावकः	śāvakaḥ	young one, cub (सिंहशावकः lion cub)
अण्डम्	aṇḍam	egg

Female forms

Male → female	Sound	Meaning
सिंहः → सिंही	siṃhī	lioness
व्याघ्रः → व्याघ्री	vyāghrī	tigress
अश्वः → अश्वा	aśvā	mare
मयूरः → मयूरी	mayūrī	peahen
हंसः → हंसी	haṃsī	female swan
गजः → करेणुः	kareṇuḥ	she-elephant
कुक्कुटः → कुक्कुटी	kukkuṭī	hen





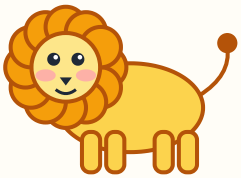
Animal sounds · ध्वनयः

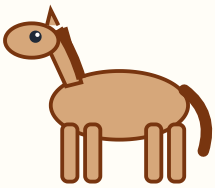
Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
सिंहः गर्जति ।	siṃhaḥ garjati	The lion roars.
गजः बृंहति ।	gajaḥ bṛṃhati	The elephant trumpets.
अश्वः हेषते ।	aśvaḥ heṣate	The horse neighs.
श्वा भषति ।	śvā bhaṣati	The dog barks.
कोकिलः कूजति ।	kokilaḥ kūjati	The koel sings (coos).
भ्रमरः गुञ्जति ।	bhramaraḥ guñjati	The bee hums.
काकः रौति ।	kākaḥ rauti	The crow caws.

गर्जनम् (roar), बृंहितम् (trumpeting), हेषा (neigh), कूजनम् (cooing), गुञ्जनम् (humming) are the noun forms.

Who makes this sound?

1. _____ गर्जति ।
2. _____ हेषते ।
3. _____ गुञ्जति ।
4. _____ कूजति ।





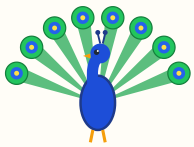


Simple sentences · सरलवाक्यानि

Sanskrit	Meaning
मयूरः नृत्यति ।	The peacock dances.
वानरः वृक्षम् आरोहति ।	The monkey climbs the tree.
अश्वः धावति ।	The horse runs.
मत्स्यः जले तरति ।	The fish swims in the water.
खगः आकाशे उड्डयते ।	The bird flies in the sky.
शुकः फलं खादति ।	The parrot eats a fruit.
पिपीलिका धान्यं वहति ।	The ant carries grain.
गौः तृणं खादति ।	The cow eats grass.

One and many · एकवचनम् बहुवचनम्

One	Many
सिंहः गर्जति ।	सिंहाः गर्जन्ति ।
मयूरः नृत्यति ।	मयूराः नृत्यन्ति ।
मत्स्यः तरति ।	मत्स्याः तरन्ति ।







Practice: sentences

Choose the verb: धावति · तरति · नृत्यति · खादति · गर्जति

1. मत्स्यः _____ ।
2. मयूरः _____ ।
3. सिंहः _____ ।
4. अश्वः _____ ।
5. शुकः फलं _____ ।

Make it plural (many)

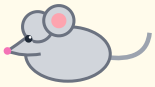
1. गजः बृंहति । → _____
2. अश्वः धावति । → _____
3. शुकः फलं खादति । → _____

Translate into Sanskrit

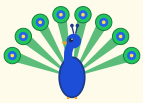
1. The cow eats grass. _____
2. The monkey climbs the tree. _____

Vāhanas of the deities · देवतानां वाहनानि

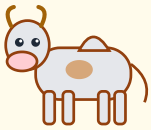
A vāhana (वाहनम्) is the “carrier” or mount of a deity.



मूषकः
mūṣakaḥ
Gaṇeśa: mouse



मयूरः
mayūraḥ
Kārttikeya (Skanda): peacock



नन्दी (वृषभः)
nandī
Śiva: the bull Nandī



गरुडः
garuḍaḥ
Viṣṇu: Garuḍa, king of birds



हंसः
haṃsaḥ
Brahmā · Sarasvatī: swan



सिंहः
siṃhaḥ
Durgā: lion

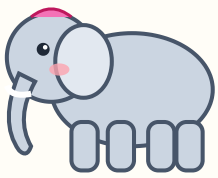


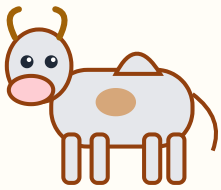
उलूकः
ulūkaḥ
Lakṣmī: owl

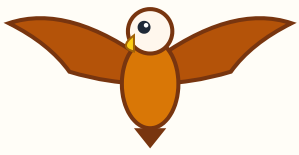
More vāhanas

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
महिषः	mahiṣaḥ	buffalo: Yama
ऐरावतः	airāvataḥ	white elephant: Indra
मेषः	meṣaḥ	ram: Agni
मकरः	makaraḥ	makara: Gaṅgā

🐾 **Did you know?** Garuḍa is called पक्षिराजः, “king of birds”. In most Śiva temples, Nandī sits facing the shrine, looking at Śiva.







Practice: vāhanas

Match the deity to the vāhana

Deity	Vāhana
1. Gaṇeśa	a. सिंहः
2. Śiva	b. मयूरः
3. Viṣṇu	c. मूषकः
4. Durgā	d. हंसः
5. Lakṣmī	e. गरुडः
6. Sarasvatī	f. उलूकः
7. Kārttikeya	g. नन्दी

Fill in

1. Indra rides the white elephant _____.
2. The vāhana of Yama is the _____ (buffalo).
3. Nandī is a _____ (bull).

Draw your favourite vāhana

A Pañcatantra story · सिंहः शशकः च

The Pañcatantra (“five books”) is a collection of animal stories said to have been told by Viṣṇuśarmā to teach wisdom to young princes. This is a short, simple retelling.

वने भासुरकः नाम सिंहः वसति स्म ।

सः प्रतिदिनम् अनेकान् पशून् मारयति स्म ।

भीताः पशवः सिंहम् अवदन् — “प्रतिदिनम् एकः पशुः स्वयं भवतः समीपम् आगमिष्यति ।”

एकदा शशकस्य वारः आगतः ।

शशकः मन्दं मन्दं गत्वा विलम्बेन सिंहस्य समीपम् अगच्छत् ।

सिंहः क्रुद्धः अभवत् ।

शशकः अवदत् — “मार्गे अन्यः सिंहः माम् अवरुद्धवान् ।”

सिंहः अवदत् — “कुत्र सः ? दर्शय ।”

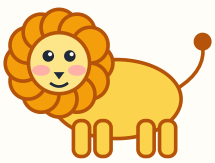
शशकः तं कूपं नीतवान् ।

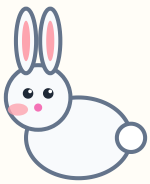
सिंहः कूपे स्वस्य प्रतिबिम्बम् अपश्यत् ।

सः “अयम् अन्यः सिंहः” इति मत्वा गर्जित्वा कूपे अपतत् ।

एवं बुद्धिमान् शशकः सर्वान् पशून् अरक्षत् ।

> **बुद्धिर्यस्य बलं तस्य ।** (buddhir yasya balaṃ tasya) Whoever has intelligence has strength.





The story: meaning & questions

1. In a forest lived a lion named Bhāsuraka.
2. Every day he killed many animals.
3. The frightened animals said to the lion, “Every day one animal will come to you by itself.”
4. One day it was the hare’s turn.
5. The hare walked very slowly and reached the lion late.
6. The lion became angry.
7. The hare said, “On the way another lion stopped me.”
8. The lion said, “Where is he? Show me.”
9. The hare led him to a well.
10. The lion saw his own reflection in the well.
11. Thinking “this is the other lion”, he roared and fell into the well.
12. So the clever hare saved all the animals.

Answer in one word

1. सिंहस्य नाम किम् ? _____
2. कः विलम्बेन अगच्छत् ? _____
3. सिंहः कुत्र अपतत् ? _____
4. What did the lion see in the well? _____

Word meanings

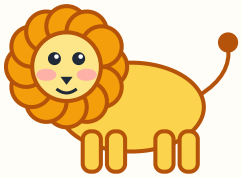
वनम् forest · वसति स्म lived · भीताः frightened · वारः turn · विलम्बेन late · क्रुद्धः angry · कूपः well · प्रतिबिम्बम् reflection · बुद्धिमान् clever

Subhāṣitas · सुभाषितानि

उद्यमेन हि सिध्यन्ति कार्याणि न मनोरथैः ।
न हि सुप्तस्य सिंहस्य प्रविशन्ति मुखे मृगाः ॥

udyamena hi sidhyanti kāryāṇi na manorathaiḥ |
na hi suptasya siṃhasya praviśanti mukhe mṛgāḥ ||

Meaning: Tasks are accomplished by effort, not by mere wishes. Deer do not walk into the mouth of a sleeping lion.



काकः कृष्णः पिकः कृष्णः को भेदः पिककाकयोः ।
वसन्तकाले सम्प्राप्ते काकः काकः पिकः पिकः ॥

kākaḥ kṛṣṇaḥ pikaḥ kṛṣṇaḥ ko bhedaḥ pikakākayoḥ |
vasantakāle samprāpte kākaḥ kākaḥ pikaḥ pikaḥ ||

Meaning: The crow is black and the cuckoo is black: what is the difference between them? When spring comes (and they sing), a crow is a crow and a cuckoo is a cuckoo. We are known by our qualities, not our looks.

Fill in

1. उद्यमेन हि सिध्यन्ति _____ न मनोरथैः ।
2. काकः कृष्णः _____ कृष्णः ।

Word search · पदान्वेषणम्

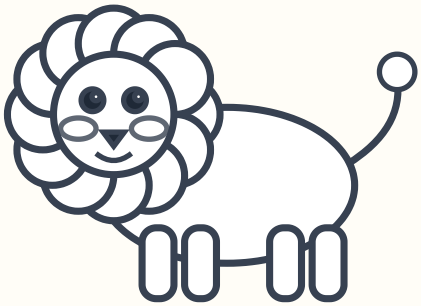
Find the 12 animal names (written in simple Roman letters without marks). Words go → ↓ or ↘. Write the Sanskrit beside each word.

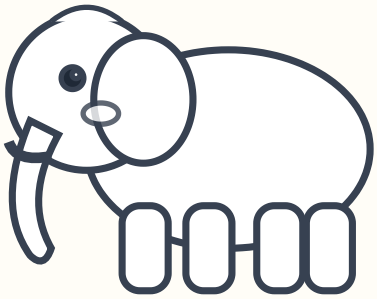
L	G	L	M	V	R	U	P	C	C	V	J
R	U	A	C	B	A	S	H	U	K	A	K
Y	K	L	J	U	P	S	K	N	M	N	A
P	M	U	U	A	M	I	H	G	V	A	D
R	A	B	R	K	H	M	H	V	K	R	E
I	Y	N	N	M	A	H	R	A	A	A	C
G	U	P	N	T	A	A	J	E	M	O	T
J	R	O	M	N	I	E	C	G	E	S	I
I	A	A	R	S	H	A	S	H	A	K	A
U	K	A	K	A	G	J	K	A	E	O	T
M	V	U	L	E	M	A	T	S	Y	A	S
V	Y	B	P	T	N	N	N	N	D	R	Y

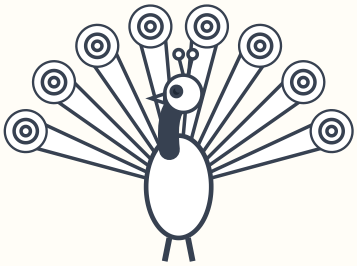
1. SIMHA = _____
2. GAJA = _____
3. ASHVA = _____
4. MAYURA = _____
5. SHUKA = _____
6. KAKA = _____
7. MATSYA = _____
8. KURMA = _____
9. HAMSA = _____
10. ULUKA = _____
11. VANARA = _____
12. SHASHAKA = _____

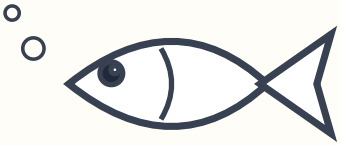
Colour the animals · रञ्जयत

Colour the animals and write each name in Sanskrit.

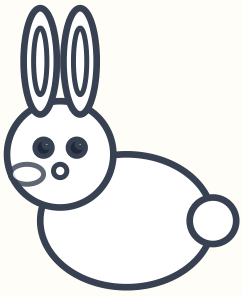


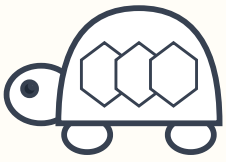












Mixed quiz · मिश्रप्रश्नाः

1. The vāhana of Gaṇeśa: _____
2. सिंहः _____ । (roars)
3. Sanskrit for “tiger”: _____
4. मत्स्यः जले _____ । (swims)
5. The young of a cow: _____
6. Female of मयूरः: _____
7. Sanskrit for “ant”: _____
8. The vāhana of Lakṣmī: _____
9. In the story, who was clever? _____
10. पिकः is another name for the _____.
11. उष्ट्रः means _____.
12. खद्योतः means _____.

Write two animals of each kind

ग्राम्यपशवः (domestic)	_____ _____
वन्यपशवः (wild)	_____ _____
पक्षिणः (birds)	_____ _____
जलचराः (water)	_____ _____

Answer key · उत्तराणि (1)

Domestic animals

Pictures: गौः · मार्जारः · अश्वः · कुक्कुटः. Match: 1b 2d 3a 4c 5e. Fill: श्वा · अजा · मूषकः

Wild animals

Pictures: गजः · शशकः · सिंहः · हरिणः. Odd one out: गौः (domestic) · मार्जारः · शुकः (a bird). Write: व्याघ्रः · भल्लूकः · शृगालः · सर्पः

Birds

Pictures: उलूकः · मयूरः · शुकः · हंसः. Fill: कोकिलः (पिकः) · काकः · कपोतः · खगः, पक्षी

Water creatures & insects

Pictures: कूर्मः · चित्रपतङ्गः · कर्कटः · पिपीलिका. Where: जले · स्थले · जले and स्थले · स्थले. True/false: false (8 legs) · true

Animal sounds

सिंहः · अश्वः · भ्रमरः · कोकिलः

Sentences

तरति · नृत्यति · गर्जति · धावति · खादति. Plural: गजाः बृंहन्ति । · अश्वाः धावन्ति । · शुकाः फलं खादन्ति ।. Translate: गौः तृणं खादति । · वानरः वृक्षम् आरोहति ।

Answer key · उत्तराणि (2)

Vāhanas

1c (मूषकः) · 2g (नन्दी) · 3e (गरुडः) · 4a (सिंहः) · 5f (उलूकः) · 6d (हंसः) · 7b (मयूरः). Fill: ऐरावतः · महिषः · वृषभः

Story

भासुरकः · शशकः · कूपे · his own reflection (प्रतिबिम्बम्)

Subhāṣitas

कार्याणि · पिकः

Word search

SIMHA सिंहः · GAJA गजः · ASHVA अश्वः · MAYURA मयूरः · SHUKA शुकः · KAKA काकः · MATSYA मत्स्यः · KURMA कूर्मः · HAMSA हंसः · ULUKA उलूकः · VANARA वानरः · SHASHAKA शशकः

Start (row, column) and direction: SIMHA 3,7 ↓ · GAJA 1,2 ↘ · ASHVA 2,6 ↘ · MAYURA 4,2 ↓ · SHUKA 2,7 → · KAKA 10,2 → · MATSYA 11,6 → · KURMA 3,2 ↘ · HAMSA 5,8 ↘ · ULUKA 2,2 ↘ · VANARA 1,11 ↓ · SHASHAKA 9,5 →

Mixed quiz

1 मूषकः · 2 गर्जति · 3 व्याघ्रः · 4 तरति · 5 वत्सः · 6 मयूरी · 7 पिपीलिका · 8 उलूकः · 9 the hare (शशकः) · 10 cuckoo (कोकिलः) · 11 camel · 12 firefly. Kinds: answers will vary.

> शोभनम्! Well done! · सर्वे जीवाः सुखिनः भवन्तु । (May all living beings be happy.)